

Hawa Mahal, Jaipur

The most striking of these are the Samrat Yantra (Sun Dial) and the Ram Yantra.

Perhaps Jaipur's most iconic sight is the Hawa Mahal, built by Sawai Pratap Singh in 1799. This five-storied pyramidal building in pink sports latticed balconies and miniature domes and is covered with delicately sculpted stone jaalis (screens). It was conceived to enable ladies of the royal household to observe royal processions and life on the streets from the privacy of their balconies.

The Amber (Amer) Fort Complex lies 11 kilometres from Jaipur. It's Palace Complex is now a UNESCO World Heritage Site. The spectacular Diwan-i-Aam and the double-storeyed painted gateway Ganesh Pol dominate the front courtyard. The Diwan-i-Khas, meanwhile, has delicate mosaic work in glass. Jas Mandir and Sukh Niwas are noted for their delicate mirrorwork.

The Albert Hall Museum is houses at the centre of Ram Niwas Bagh and has an exquisite collection of metal objects, wood crafts, carpets, weapons and so on.

Other attractions include the Jaigarh and Nahargarh Forts, the ancient pilgrimage site of Galta Ji and the magical Jal Mahal.

Not to be missed are Jaipur's lively markets, sweet shops, boutiques and lip-smacking street food.

Jaipur's most iconic sight is the Hawa Mahal, built by Sawai Pratap Singh in 1799. This five storied pyramidal building in pink sports latticed balconies and miniature domes and is covered with delicately sculpted stone jaalis (screens).

Jodhpur

Founded by Rao Jodha of the Rathore clan in 1459, the city of Jodhpur is dominated by the Mehrangarh Fort, sitting at 125 metres on top of a rocky hill surrounded by a 10-km-long high wall. There are many magnificent palaces within the fort, including Moti Mahal, Phool Mahal, Sheesh Mahal, the Sileh Khana and the Daulat Khana. They contain and excellent collection of royal objects. The 20th-century Umaid Bhawan Palace was built as a famine relief project to provide employment to



